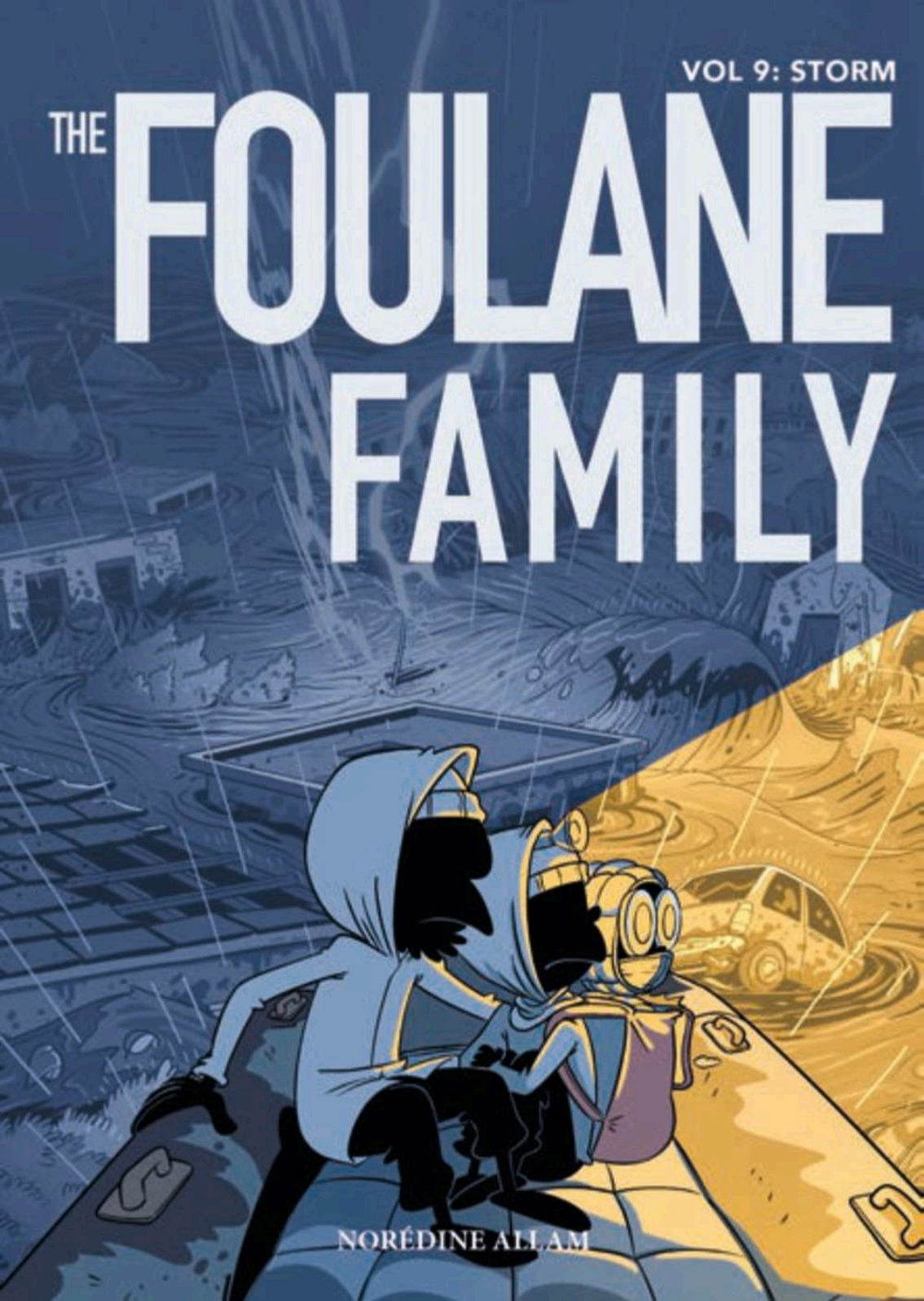
VOL 9: STORM

THE FOULANE FAMILY



NORÉDINE ALLAM

THE FOULANE FAMILY

Vol 9. The Storm

Written and illustrated by
Norédine Allam
Editorial director
Karim Allam

BDouin®



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

The Foulane Family

Vol.9

The Storm

By Norédine Allam.

BDouin Édition · Rights sample · Not for distribution

March 2023 - 5000 copies
Edition with color images - Printed in Turkey by IMAK
Any reproduction, partial or total, of this publication
is prohibited without written permission from the publisher.

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

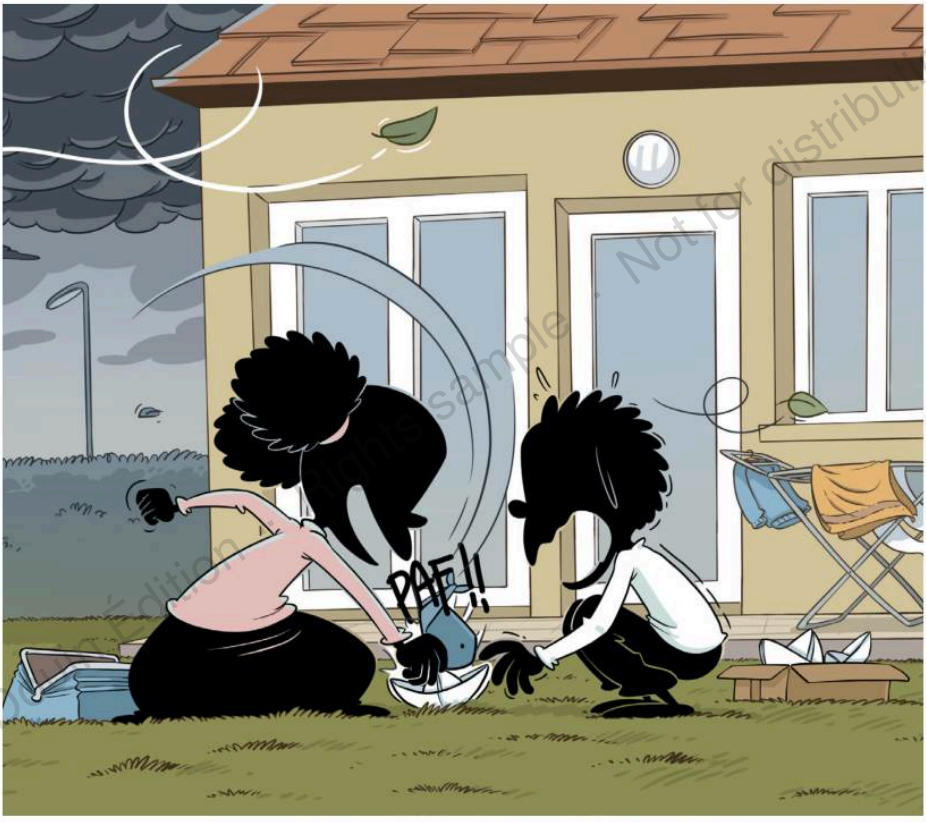
1. The wind is picking up

BDouin Édition · Rights sample · Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Me and Binti spent the afternoon in the garden. It was mid-autumn. The ideal season to play outside, even if it was a little cold.

A formidable paper-based battle was underway. It all started with a book of Japanese origami that Oummi had bought us the day before.



“Blue whale attack!!” Binti said, smashing my boat with the long tail of her folded blue cardboard marine mammal.

“Oi, that’s not fair!” I protested.

“Of course it is!” She replied. “And if you think that isn’t fair, wait for me to attack you with my latest invention!”

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Then, she opened up her bag and pulled out a yellow grasshopper.



"Pff! That's no match for my war machines," I boasted. But just as I was about to destroy it with my Terratroctor, a huge jet of flames burst out of the grasshopper's mouth and charred my origami creation, just like an onion left on the barbecue!



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition, contact@bdouin.com

“But... but that’s not fair!” I complained. “How did you even do that?”

“Aha! I created a mini blowtorch system using a lighter from the kitchen,” she responded while showing the insides of her beast.

Okay! She asked for it...

Without warning, I grabbed her little grasshopper and placed it on the back of my most recent folding model: my E471 bomber.

Then I threatened to send them both high into the sky.



Obviously, Binti sneered and laughed at me saying that my plane wouldn’t be able to move more than a metre off the ground.

We were about to find out...

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

I stepped two steps back, took a deep breath and ran forward at full speed, brandishing my plane high above me.

"Take-off bomber!!" I screamed, throwing it as hard as I could.

Well, believe it or not, my plane flew far into the sky like never before! It seemed to float and bounce off the clouds.



It was beautiful to see, but also sad – I'd just said goodbye to the only paper airplane of mine that had actually worked!

"See..? Who's the best now!?" I called out to Binti anyway, in a taunting tone.

"Hmm... that's weird," Binti commented.

"What? Are you jealous?!"

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

"No, that's not it... Have you noticed how strong the wind is?" Binti asked.

Hmm, she wasn't wrong. Looking at the pavement, I noticed that the wheelie bins were no longer standing upright.



Some were rolling, while others were vomiting their contents out onto the road. The trees, on the other hand, were dancing in rhythm to the slamming of open windows.

The wind was so strong that it even rocked cars parked on the road.

For our part, me and Binti had a hard time standing. At first, it was fun, but after a few uncontrolled falls, it had become downright dangerous.

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

It was at this moment that Oummi's voice echoed in the sky, carried by the air:

"Kids!! You have to come home quickly!"

Game over. It was time to take cover.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

2. The power of three

BDouin Édition · Rights sample · Not for distribution

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Before returning, we did our best to pick up the washing that was out on the patio but the wind was blowing so hard that the clothes zigzagged up into the sky like balloons released from their strings.

"My floral socks!!" Binti shouted, trying to catch one in mid-flight.



"Leave them! It's too dangerous!" I intervened, holding her by the elbow.

As soon as we cross the threshold into the kitchen, Oummi closed the door behind us with a big shoulder tap.

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

It looked like she's been training to be an American football player!



Phew We were now safe.

"Come on children, we've got to hurry!" she shouted, before rushing upstairs. "We must close all the blinds!"

We barely had time to recover from the shock of being outside. Me and Binti worked together to close the blinds of each window in the living room one by one.

I supported the upright part of the crank tightly, while Binti turned it at full speed.



Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Unfortunately for us, one of the slats of the blinds had jammed halfway – something must have blocked the mechanism.

I opened the window, so we could see more clearly. Big mistake...

No sooner had I turned the handle slightly, then the powerful raging wind push the window wide open in the blink of an eye.

The impact threw me backwards more than two metres as I tucked myself into a ball. Binti was flying mid-air holding onto the crank's handle for dear life!



Leaves, branches, rain and dust were now entering the house, carried by this whistling whirlwind! We had to act quickly.

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

Inspired by an educational book about American farmers, I grabbed the curtain cord, tied a quick knot, and walked towards that wild window, which kept slamming and banging on the wall.

There, in one quick movement, I grabbed the handle with my rope with my first throw, just as a Texan would have done with his lasso.



Then I pulled back on the rope with all my might! The window was now almost closed. But to finish the job, I needed a little help.

“Binti!” I screamed. “Close the handle, quickly! I’m not going to be able to hold on for long...”

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com

She then pounced on the handle and gave a sharp blow down. CHLACK! She then hurried back to the handle and finished lowering the blind. Mission accomplished!

Phew. Lying on the ground, me and Binti came to our senses, among the leaves and debris that the wind had carried to the ground.



That's when Oummi appeared.

"Bah! What are you children doing?" Oummi asked. "Now is not the time for napping!"

Napping? Oummi mustn't have heard the terrible fight that had been raging just a few seconds ago.

"Come on, come on! Let's get active! And clean everything up!" Oummi called out as she settled on the sofa.

Sample for rights evaluation only. © BDouin Édition. contact@bdouin.com